

Bedtime Tales

Zara and the Tiny Ladybird



KIDS BOOK VIDEOS



Zara was a small girl, six years old, who loved playing in the garden. One morning she spotted a ladybird — tiny and red with black dots — crawling along a green leaf. Zara felt a rush of excitement and reached out fast to pick it up. The ladybird tumbled off the leaf.



Her heart beat fast with worry. "Did I hurt it?" she whispered.



Grandma knelt beside her. "I see you feel worried," Grandma said. Zara nodded. "It is okay to feel worried," Grandma said softly. "It shows you care."



Then Grandma showed her how. "Gentle hands keep little friends safe," she said. "Gentle hands keep little friends safe," she said again. "Gentle hands keep little friends safe," she said one more time.



Zara held out her hand, flat and very still and very soft. The ladybird crawled onto her finger. Tickle, tickle. Zara giggled quietly. "It tickles!" she whispered. She watched its tiny legs and shiny wings. "You are so small," she breathed, "and so brave."



She lowered her hand to a flower, and the ladybird crawled off, waved its wings, and flew away. "Bye, little friend," Zara said. She felt happy — she had been gentle, and being gentle felt good.



That afternoon Zara was gentle with everything. She stroked the cat softly, watered the flowers carefully, and spoke in a quiet voice. Grandma smiled. "You have gentle hands and a gentle heart," she said.



At bedtime, Zara snuggled under her blanket and thought about the ladybird, flying somewhere in the night. She had felt worried that morning, but now she felt peaceful. The garden crickets sang softly — chirp, chirp, hush.



Zara closed her eyes. She was gentle. She was loved.



Goodnight, Zara.

**Gentle hands and a gentle heart
keep small creatures safe.**

The End

